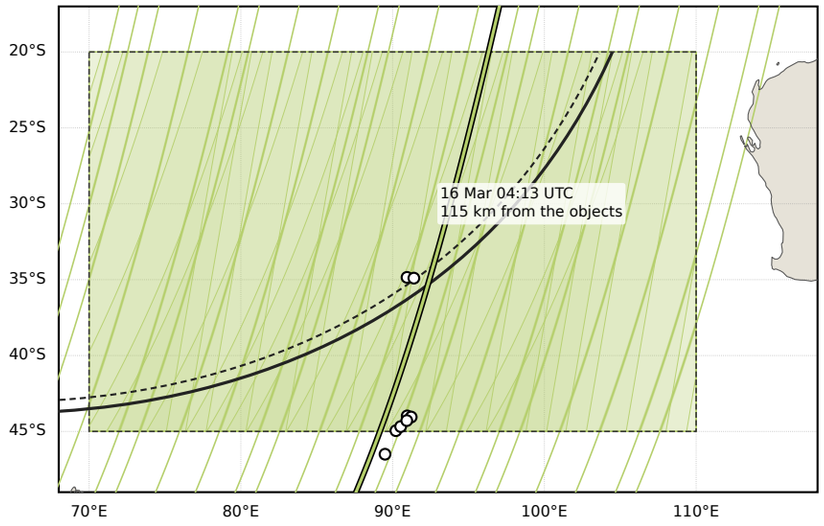
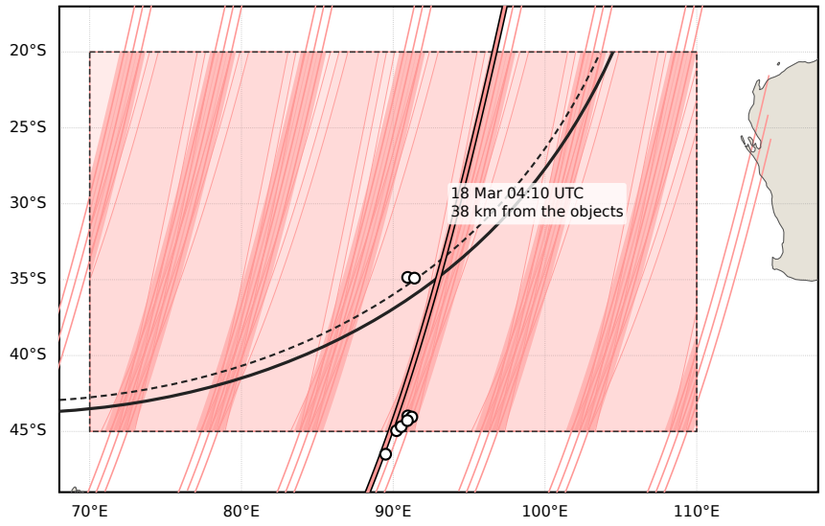
Satellite imaging access, 16 to 27 Mar 2014: satellites known or reported to have been used, with the reported object positions

Coloured line: path of the point below the satellite on each usable pass (optical: daylight; radar: any time). Filled strip: ground imaged looking straight down. Faint tint and outline: full reach by pointing off-nadir. Black-edged pass with a label: the pass on which the published image was taken, and the ground distance from its path to the reported objects. White circles: positions of objects reported from satellite images (DigitalGlobe 16 Mar, Gaofen-1 18 Mar, COSMO-SkyMed 21 Mar, Airbus 23 Mar, Pléiades 23 Mar, THEOS 24 Mar, Japan 26 Mar). Black solid: 7th arc; dashed: 6th arc; dashed box: study area.

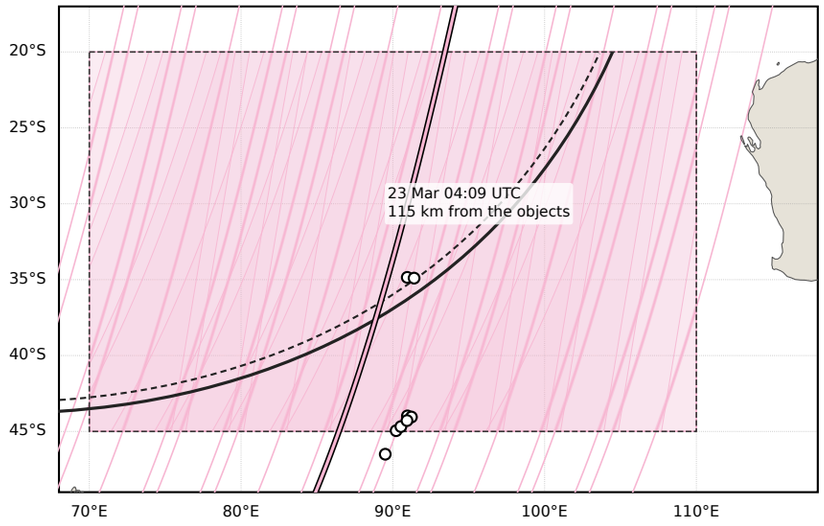
a WorldView-2: 22 passes, 20 with the 7th arc in reach



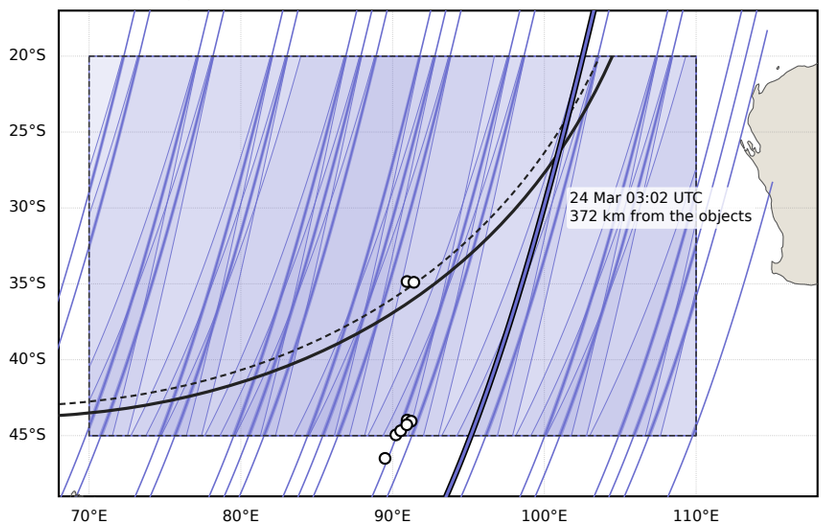
b Gaofen-1: 24 passes, 20 with the 7th arc in reach



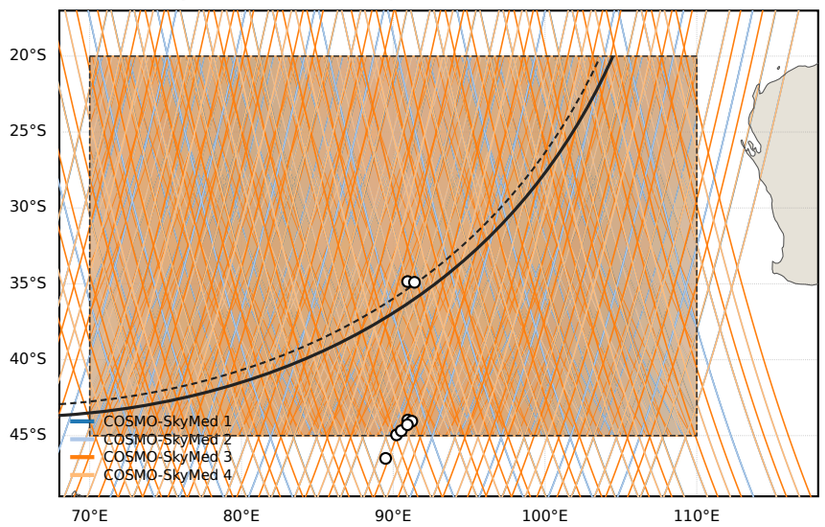
c Pleiades-1A: 22 passes, 21 with the 7th arc in reach



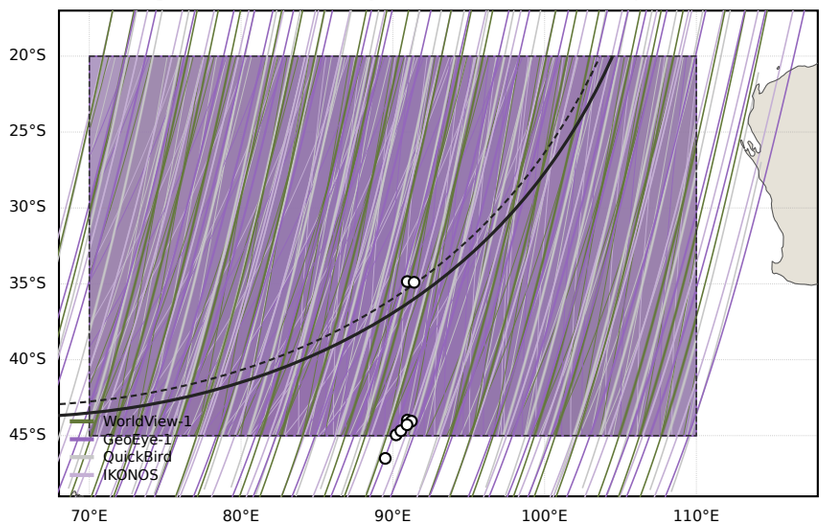
d THEOS: 22 passes, 18 with the 7th arc in reach



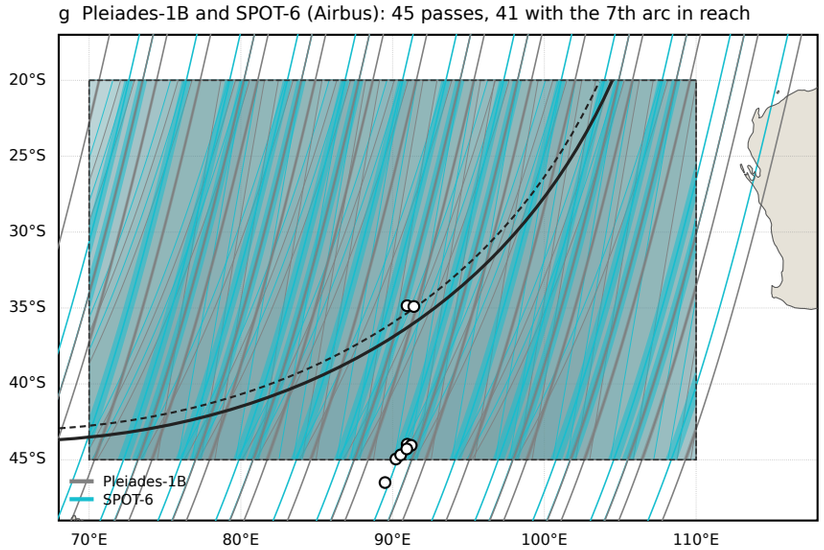
e COSMO-SkyMed 1-4 (radar): 183 passes, 143 with the 7th arc in reach



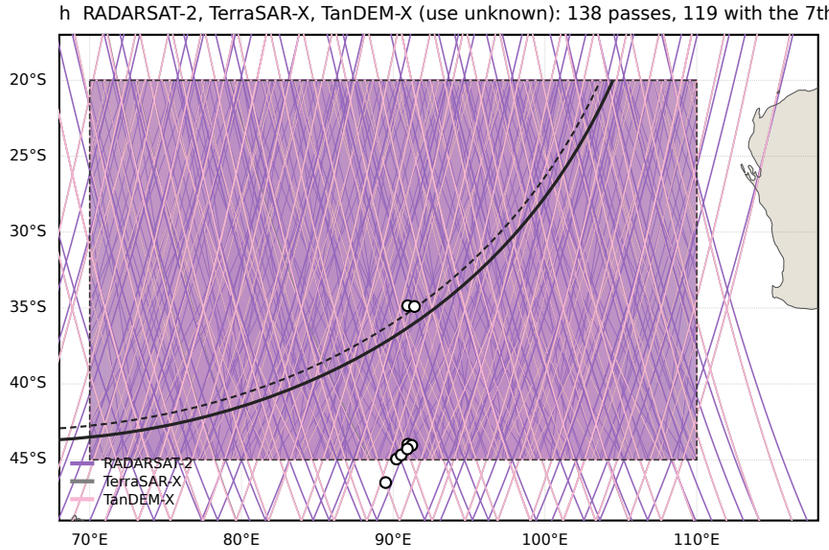
f Other DigitalGlobe: WV-1, GeoEye-1, QuickBird, IKONOS: 93 passes, 86 with the 7th a



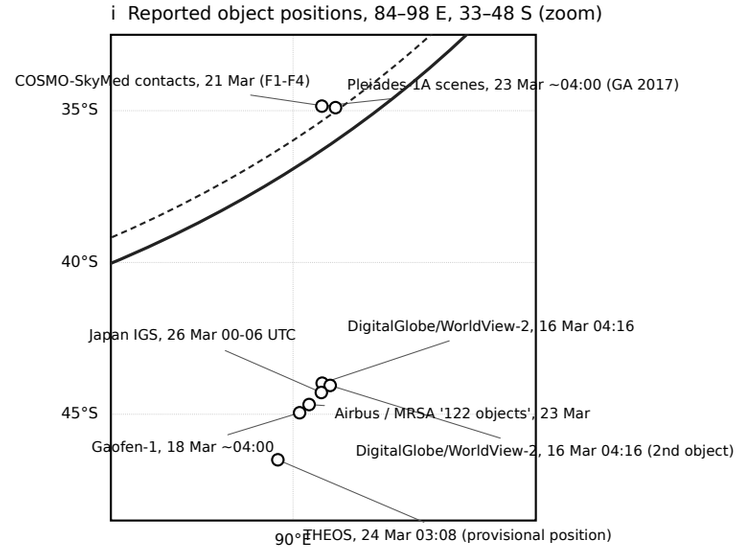
g Pleiades-1B and SPOT-6 (Airbus): 45 passes, 41 with the 7th arc in reach



h RADARSAT-2, TerraSAR-X, TanDEM-X (use unknown): 138 passes, 119 with the 7th arc in reach



i Reported object positions, 84–98 E, 33–48 S (zoom)



Plain-language note: In this period several agencies did task satellites over the southern Indian Ocean. The whole coloured area is where each satellite could have looked; the published images are small scenes (about 10–60 km across) inside these areas, and no agency has published their footprints. The positions shown for the Airbus, THEOS and Japanese images are read from released maps and are approximate. The spacecraft behind the Airbus '122 objects' image, the French radar images and the Japanese image are not identified; IGS, Helios and SAR-Lupe 1/2/4 cannot be drawn because no March 2014 element sets exist in public sources.

Technical: same propagation and access rules as the 7–15 Mar maps. Known-pass check: WorldView-2 closest approach to 43.98 S 90.96 E at 04:15:40 UTC on 16 Mar (published 04:16), 119 km off-nadir ground distance (8.3°); THEOS closest approach to 46.5 S 89.5 E at 03:08:00 on 24 Mar (published 03:07:56), 372 km (incidence 26.9° vs 26.98° published). Sighting coordinates: DIGO sheets (DigitalGlobe), SASTIND release (Gaofen-1), MOT Malaysia map (Airbus/MRSA), GA Record 2017/13 (Pléiades, centroid of rating-5 objects), project cosmo-contacts.csv (COSMO-SkyMed F1–F4 centroid), GISTDA sheets (THEOS, provisional), Japan Cabinet Office release (IGS, 10 km radius).